



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 51

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Working Safely in Occupied or Partially Occupied Buildings

OVERVIEW:

Interior finish work performed in buildings that are occupied or partially occupied introduces hazards for building occupants that do not exist on a fully closed construction site. Dust, noise, chemical vapors, trip hazards, and falling objects from overhead work can all affect occupants who are not

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. Dust containment is the most visible and most impactful protection we can provide to building occupants. Before starting any work that generates significant dust, erect proper barriers — plastic sheeting sealed at all edges, dust-rated construction barriers, or temporary wall systems. Verify that the HVAC system serving the construction area is isolated or filtered to prevent dust
2. Chemical vapors from adhesives, caulks, stains, and solvents are invisible but can migrate significant distances from the application point. In occupied buildings, use water-based, low-VOC products whenever possible. Where solvent-based products are required, schedule application during off-hours when occupants are not present, and provide maximum ventilation before occupants return.
3. Noise is a significant concern for building occupants who are trying to work, sleep, or receive services during construction. Schedule high-noise operations — pneumatic nailers, circular saws, hammering — during hours that minimize impact on occupants, and give advance notice for particularly disruptive operations. Acoustic isolation barriers can reduce noise transmission and
4. Tool and material security at the end of every shift is critical in occupied buildings. Every unsecured tool, piece of sharp material, open chemical container, and construction hazard is accessible to building occupants who are not construction workers and who may not recognize the hazard. Walk your work area at the end of every shift with security and cleanliness as the

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: What is the daily work schedule and notification protocol for occupants on this project?
Q2: Walk through our dust containment setup — is every edge of every barrier sealed?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Erect proper dust barriers before beginning any work in occupied spaces
- Inform building occupants about loud or high-dust operations in advance
- Secure all tools and materials at end of every shift — public safety first
- Use low-VOC products wherever possible in all occupied spaces
- Maintain clear emergency egress at all times — never block exits

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 51

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)	#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)
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